comment a couple of days earlier on the entrepreneurial skills of shikanjiwalas, dhabawalas and mechanics, Jaitley took a dig at the Congress leader's dynastic origins: 'The great grandson of the man who authored "*The Discovery of India*" [Jawaharlal Nehru] could with his customary inaccuracies one day give to this country his monumental work on "The Rediscovery of Coca Cola" … Dynastic political parties are family and personality dominated. Ideology takes a back seat. You can oppose the OBC when it suits you. You can shed crocodile tears for them when the opportunism so requires. You can run down jobs created by frying *pakodas*. You can quantify on the virtues of running a *dhaba*. The leader's ill-informed instincts become the ideology. This can only happen to a party which becomes ideologyless; pushes itself to the fringe; is willing to act as a tailender to regional parties. All this because its only obsession is a person called Narendra Modi.'[7]

Now, as the primary ideological opponent of the Congress, it was natural for the BJP to speak so much about its rival. Yet, the remarkable increase in its anti-Congress discourse points to a key political lesson that the party's strategic planners drew on: comparing the BJP to the Congress. In this messaging, the Congress's failures became the BJP's greatest strength. Essentially, the party positioned itself as everything its main rival was not. At the heart of the new communication was one core message: that the Congress remained a dynastic party, while the BJP, generally, was not. This was a core message at a time when most Indians had become disenchanted with claims about entitlement based on birth.[8]

A good illustration of this is what then party president Amit Shah told a gathering of intellectuals at Budha Mal castle in Palampur in May 2017: 'Out of 1,650 small and big parties in the country, only and only BJP is one in which internal democracy survives—it is one where every three years from the booth to the national president, elections are held in a timely manner as per its constitution. *You cannot tell who its next president will be, but who the Congress's next president will be, everyone knows. Everyone knows who will be the next president of regional parties, but our party's democracy is such that even a booth-level worker can become party president and a poor man's son can become prime minister* … The Congress is